



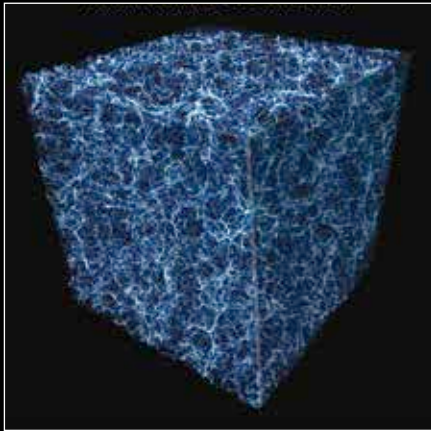
Your name in space

If you want your name to be left on an asteroid, send a mail to NASA now <http://dgit.in/AsterName>



Spaceship on comet

Rosetta spacecraft is about ready to wake and prepare to land <http://dgit.in/CometLand>



The zoomed in part of the image is only a small part of the cosmic web and measures 10 million light years across. It oddly looks like a Borg Cube. *shudder*

2 million light year-long nebula of gas was illuminated by the quasar. The 10 billion light year distance between the quasar and the Earth paints a remarkable picture of the cosmic past due to the time taken for the light to travel.

Star Power - The Hottest and The Largest

Currently the hottest star in the cold deadness of space is the white dwarf in the centre of NGC 6537 or as it is popularly known - the Red Spider Nebula. Here the surface temperature reach up to 300,000 degrees Celsius, which is 50 times hotter than the sun in our solar system. The Big Bang is estimated to have ignited at the unimaginable hellish Planck temperature 1.416×10^{32} Kelvin and since then the Universe has only cooled down. The exception

being when in July 2012 the scientists at CERN created a quark-gluon plasma that briefly existed at 5.5 trillion degrees Kelvin. Cool.

The largest star that's been found so far is NML Cygni purely based on its radius which is 1,650 times that of the Sun and is located 5,300 light years from Earth. Although it is the largest in size when compared to currently measured stars, it isn't the most massive. The NML Cygni star is only 25-40 times the mass of our sun, whereas R136a1 or the Wolf-Rayet star, is estimated to be 265 times the mass of our sun. Not only is the Wolf-Rayet star the most massive star known it is also the most luminous, shining 8.7 million times as much as the Sun. However, due to its 165,000 light year distance from Earth, it's shine is not that clearly visible. But perhaps if we squint we might catch something.

The Largest Galaxy

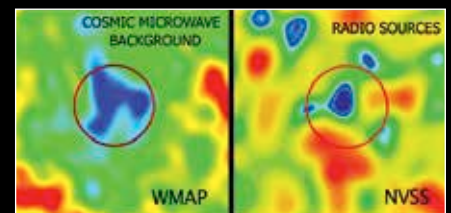
The Universe is nearly 84 per cent dark matter, with empty space that separates cosmological structures that are held together by gravity from each other. Galaxies are separated by nothingness and form a closed structure that can reach extraordinary scale. The IC 1101 is the largest of all these galaxies that has ever been discovered. Originally seen by William Herschel on 19 June 1790 in the constellation of Virgo, where this supergiant elliptical galaxy is the heart of the Abell 2029 galaxy cluster.

Scientist estimate that this super galaxy was formed over the eons as it merged with many more smaller galaxies

that were part of its cluster. The IC 1101 super galaxy covers an expanse of 6 million light years in size which makes it 60 times larger than the size of the Milky Way galaxy in which our solar system exists.

Void To Parallel Dimensions

In the Universe, nothing happens small - even emptiness. The Boötes Void and the CMB Cold Spot are examples of how the Universe has an odd way of distributing itself in unpredictable ways. The Boötes Void is a near spherical region of space in the constellation Boötes, that is 250 million light years across but as the name suggests - empty, at least by universe standards. With only 60 galaxies it is the least populated area of observable space.



For some reason the bluey part in the middle of the greeny part makes scientist think of parallel universes. Psychedelic.

However, the CMB cold spot is a whole other kettle of fish altogether. Recorded by the Wilkinson Microwave Anisotropy Probe (WMAP). It was initially a simple statistical aberration that indicated an unexpected cold area in the Universe. Considered by many to be a supervoid it was unable to fit the cosmological models of that definition when further research was conducted. All applied and known research indicated that it could be 6 to 10 billion light years away and nearly one billion light years across in size. The sheer improbability of its existence forced scientists to consider many radical explanations.

The strangest and perhaps most fun explanation came from Laura Mersini-Houghton who claimed that the CMB cold spot pointed to the evidence of another universe that was visible due to quantum entanglement. And although the theory is stuck due to available data, if this theory proved true then it may not only prove the evidence of parallel universes but also support string theory.



Red Spider Nebula